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Genetic Social Psychology: From Microgenesis to Ontogenesis, Sociogenesis . . . and Back

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Introduction

As recently argued by Valsiner (2013, p. ix), psychology is in deep crisis because of its success in amassing large quantities of empirical evidence but rarely addressing the question "What for?" Valsiner refers to the life work of the late Gerard Duveen as "a good illustration of what kind of scholarship could bring psychology out of its crisis of limited generalization value", even going so far as to state that genetic social psychology, is "the idea that will live" (Valsiner, 2013, p. ix). Moscovici (2010) states that the work of Duveen inspired some of his writings (see Moscovici, 1990), and that Duveen "had been able to raise fundamental epistemological questions and to propose some elements of answer on which we must reflect further" (p.2.4).

Duveen's vision of genetic social psychology was a particular form of social developmental psychology based on a dual commitment to think with and against both Jean Piaget and Serge Moscovici (Duveen, 2001; Moscovici et al., 2013). It is uniquely situated to transcend the current fragmentation, which often resembles the well-documented effects of ingroup/outgroup differentiation between the two subdisciplines: social psychology and developmental psychology.

This chapter reviews and builds on two lines of research, that propose some of the building blocks of genetic social psychology. The first explores the role of social interaction in cognitive development in the educational context. It is directly related to the legacy of Gerard Duveen (see Moscovici et al., 2013) and his work in Cambridge, which was

recently expanded upon at the University of Cyprus forming one strand of the "third generation of research in peer interaction and cognitive development" (Leman & Duveen, 1999; Psaltis, 2005a; Psaltis & Duveen, 2006, 2007; Duveen & Psaltis, 2008; Psaltis et al., 2009; Psaltis, 2011a, 2011b, 2012a, 2012b, 2012c; Zapiti, 2012; Psaltis & Zapiti, 2014).

In a series of studies, we observed peer interaction in the educational context of collaborative problem-solving but related these social interactive processes to the sociocultural and historical context of social representations of gender, while retaining the strengths of a structural analysis of Piagetian constructivism. This series of studies explored the interplay of representations and identities through the articulation of intrapersonal with interpersonal, intergroup and ideological/social representational dynamics (Doise, 1986; Perret-Clermont, Chapter 4, this volume), building on Piagetian insights into the role of social relations in cognitive development (Piaget, 1932/1965) and his social psychology (Kitchener, 2009), together with the seminal work of the Social Genevans on peer interaction and cognitive development (Doise et al., 1976; Perret-Clermont, 1980).

The second line of research was initiated at the Oxford Centre for the Study of Intergroup Conflict in 2005 and it is currently being continued at the University of Cyprus. It explores the role of social interaction in the reduction of prejudice based on Allport's (1954) contact hypothesis and its recent developments. Here we have been exploring the effects of social interaction (termed "intergroup contact" in the field) between Turkish Cypriots (TCs) and Greek Cypriots (GCs) on the reduction of prejudice and the promotion of trust at different ages (Tausch et al., 2010; Psaltis, 2012a). More recently we have also embarked on interdisciplinary work with history educators and historians, exploring the interplay between representations of history and contact (Lytra & Psaltis, 2011; Psaltis et al., 2011; Psaltis, 2012a), as well as deepening the exploration of the internal heterogeneity of social identity positions within conflicting societies as they produce and valorize cultural artefacts as symbols of intergroup relations (Psaltis et al., 2014), or structure the oral historical accounts about life in formerly mixed villages in Cyprus (Psaltis et al., 2014).

This chapter suggests ways in which the genetic social psychological framework, which aims at the articulation of microgenetic, ontogenetic and sociogenetic processes, could be applied to the field of intergroup contact and the reduction of prejudice in the light of accumulated evidence from these two lines of research.

Genetic social psychology

In viewing social representations theory as a genetic theory, Duveen and Lloyd (1990) argue that a genetic perspective is implied in the conception of social representations, in the sense that the structure of any particular social representation is a construction and thus the outcome of some developmental process. Three types of transformation associated with social representation as a process are proposed: (1) microgenesis, which concerns the evocation and (re)construction of social representations in the microtime of social interactions; (2) ontogenesis, which concerns the development of individuals in relation to social representations during their lifetime; and (3) sociogenesis, which concerns the construction and transformation of the social representations of social groups with regard to specific objects in historical time.

Microgenesis as the motor of ontogenesis and sociogenesis

People communicate in social interaction and thus social representations are *evoked* through the social identities asserted in the activity of individuals. A process of negotiation and (re)construction of social representations of Self, Other and Object is also taking place in social interaction. From the genetic point of view, microgenesis holds a privileged and central position as it is the motor for the ontogenesis and sociogenesis of social representations (Duveen & Lloyd, 1990). Microgenesis can thus be seen as "the genetic process in all social interaction in which particular social identities and the social representations on which they are based are elaborated and negotiated" (Duveen & Lloyd, 1990, p.8; Psaltis, in press).

Duveen and Lloyd's (1990) definition is focused on change as a form of construction through sociocognitive conflict in social interaction, but it is unique because it implicates in this process social identity and social representations. According to this perspective, the evocation of social representations in social interaction occurs when individuals construct an understanding of the situation and position themselves and their interlocutors as social psychological subjects in the field of social representations. This process can run smoothly along the lines of the "taken for granted" but it can also lead to ruptures (see Zittoun et al., 2003) that cause doubt and reflection in the social psychological subject.

The microgenesis of a social representation implies reorganization leading to the formation of a holistic structure with a certain coherence

since the basic function of social representations is to make the unfamiliar familiar. Such processes of microgenesis are situated in groups and they are reciprocally shaped by sociogenetic processes, implicating public and mass-mediated communication within and across groups in historical time (Wagner, 2003).

In the first line of research we did not have the chance to explore sociogenetic processes. We instead concentrated on the links between microgenesis and ontogenesis in childhood, exploring the interplay between social representations of gender and the coconstruction of new knowledge about cognitive Piagetian tasks in 6–7- and 10–11-year-olds (see Psaltis & Zapiti, 2014 for an overview). The lack of emphasis on sociogenetic processes in our first line of research left us open to a critique raised by Nicolopoulou and Weintraub (2009) – namely, that the third generation of research in peer interaction and cognitive development did not yet offer a comprehensive sociocultural framework for the study of human development. In what follows, after presenting the first line of research, a window is opened onto the study of sociogenetic processes through the study of longer-term changes that take place in historical time in the context of prejudice reduction through intergroup contact. The exploration of such historic processes and changes became possible after the opening of checkpoints on 23 April 2003 in the UN-patrolled buffer zone in divided Cyprus.

From microgenesis to ontogenesis: The role of social identities

The social developmental approach of genetic social psychology takes the social-psychological subject as the unit of analysis and provides theoretical insights into the ontogenesis of social representations of gender (Duveen & Lloyd, 1990), the relations between social representations and identities (Duveen, 1997, 2001) and empirical evidence of the microgenesis of social representations and the importance of distinctions between varieties of communication or social interaction and their links with forms of learning or cognitive development (Leman & Duveen, 1999; Duveen, 2002; Psaltis & Duveen, 2006, 2007; Duveen & Psaltis, 2008; Psaltis et al., 2009).

In this work the experimental microgenetic paradigm of the Social Genevans is applied in order to explore how children at the age of 6–7 years old interact under conditions in which an asymmetry of gender status is crossed with an asymmetry of knowledge about cognitive tasks (Psaltis & Duveen, 2006, 2007; Duveen & Psaltis, 2008; Psaltis, 2011a; Psaltis, in press; Psaltis, 2014; Psaltis et al., 2009). The effects of such

criss-crossing of asymmetries on conversation types and on the change of the representation of the conservation of liquids and the village task (see Doise & Mugny, 1984) was explored (for reviews of and commentaries on this work, see Simao, 2003; Ferrari, 2007; Martin, 2007; Nicolopoulou & Weintraub, 2009; Psaltis et al., 2009; Maynard, 2009; Castorina, 2010; Jovchelovitch, 2010; Leman, 2010; Marková, 2010; Psaltis, 2011b; Sorsana & Trognon, 2011). In this kind of work one can clearly see the interplay between two processes of representation: the process of socially representing gender and the process of evoking and actively renegotiating the representation of the cognitive task. This is a dual opportunity for the reconstruction of knowledge of representations of the task and of gender in social interaction. From this perspective, both representations could be rightfully termed social representations.

Positioning in the collaborative dyadic problem-solving of a cognitive task in 6–7-year-olds can be either consistent with or in conflict with expectations about habitual, and mostly unreflective, ways of positioning the gendered self derived from presuppositions of social representations of gender. These are the same "presuppositions buried under the layers of words and images", as discussed by Moscovici (1994, p. 168). A girl positioned as a novice by a boy asserting himself as an expert may find this situation all too familiar, while a boy who finds himself positioned as a novice by a girl may find that this conflicts with his expectations of an expression of a certain traditional masculinity. Indeed, this is exactly what is shown through our studies with the empirically well-established "Fm effect" (Zittoun et al., 2003; Psaltis, 2005a, 2005b, 2011a; Psaltis & Duveen, 2006, 2007; Duveen & Psaltis, 2008; Psaltis et al., 2009; Zapiti & Psaltis, 2012; Psaltis & Zapiti, 2014). We have consistently found that the conflicting nature of gender status and knowledge asymmetries in dyadic interaction of the female expert–male novice (Fm) creates a more balanced communication between the interlocutors. Such communication is linked with more flexible and novel forms of knowledge, interiorization of operations and in-depth understanding of the object under discussion. Jovchelovitch vividly describes the "Fm effect" in Duveen (2002, p. 148), saying "what the girls are doing is they are bringing the boys an apple, and when the boys bite into it, it becomes new knowledge for them". This effect resonates with the Vygotskian method of "double stimulation". It is unfortunate that Vygostkian scholarship has failed to address the role of status asymmetries in interaction and their role in the zone of proximal development. There are many reasons for this, not least mistranslation (Cole, personal communication, 5/2/2013) of the comments by

Vygotsky (1978) on Piaget's distinction between relations of constraint and relations of cooperation in Piaget (1932/1965) (see Psaltis & Zapiti, 2014 for an extended discussion of this point).

Another innovation of the third generation of research is the introduction of a more molar level of analysis of unfolding communication going beyond the coding of singular conversation moves towards the coding of extended microgenetic time by distinguishing different types of conversation or interaction types. Rather than analysing particular speech acts or sequential patterns of speech acts, this analysis has considered the conversations across the interaction as a whole, and has differentiated four conversation or interaction types that can be related to different forms of social recognition between the interlocutors. For example, in the conservation of liquids task, the following conversation types were identified:

- *Non-conserving*: The non-conserving child was able to persuade their conserving partner to agree on a wrong joint response of non-conservation. Most of the cases took the form of passive acceptance of the non-conserving position by the conserver.
- *No Resistance*: Here, conversations began with an assertion of conservation by the conserving child to which the non-conserving child offered no resistance. It is thus a reverse kind of passive acceptance compared with the previous type.
- *Resistance*: In these conversations the non-conserver offered an argument in support of their position at least once during the interaction.
- *Explicit recognition*: These are conversations in which the non-conserving child gave some explicit indication that they had grasped the idea of conservation, or even a conserving argument, forming a kind of intersubjectivity in a temporarily shared world (Rommetveit, 1974), where both individuals became explicitly aware not only of the other's perspective (metaperspective), but also of the fact that the other's metaperspective agreed with their own (forming a joint metametaperspective) (see Gillespie, Chapter 6, this volume). Such a conversation type is characterized by a form of recognition of the original non-conserver as a thinking subject (Psaltis & Duveen, 2007) or an autonomous agent, and the influence taking place here is bidirectional.

The coding of interaction at this molar level of analysis provided a clearer and stronger pattern of relationships between this feature of

the interaction and the outcome for the original non-conservers in the post-test. Progress in the post-test was observed for almost every child who participated in an *explicit recognition* conversation (Psaltis & Duveen, 2006), but never for those from *non-conserving* conversations. And while about half of the children from *no resistance* and *resistance* interactions made progress in the post-test, they did so without producing any novelty in that test. Novelty was almost exclusively observed in the post-tests of children who had participated in *explicit recognition* (Psaltis & Duveen, 2006).

On the contrary, in *incorrect answer* and *no resistance* there appeared to be at play a form of *instrumental recognition* where one of the partners was relegated by the Other to an object that either just filled in the slots offered by the other or was not taken into account at all. The influence was unidirectional. Finally, *resistance* seemed to be a form of categorical recognition where there was a limit to the unidirectional influence that could be achieved by the Other due to their social category membership.

Most of these studies had 6–7-year-old Greek Cypriot elementary school students as their subjects. However, children of different ages reconstruct and enact social representations of gender differently (Leman, 2010), and for this reason the research programme has recently expanded towards exploring the same questions with older children of 10–11 years (Zapiti, 2012; Psaltis & Zapiti, 2014) and adolescents (Psaltis, Panayi & Zapiti, in preparation) in Piagetian formal operational tasks. The corresponding findings in older children of both 10–11 and 14–15 years confirm the existence of the "Fm effect" and the same links between the four conversation types and progress. However, preliminary evidence suggests that in older children, gender identity dynamics are no longer detectable in social interaction but only in the individual internalized dialogue in the post-interaction period.

Having already explored the contours of a model of transition from pre-operational to operational thought in children through the study of varying forms of communication, such processes could be expanded to produce a more general model of the role of social relations and communicative forms (Duveen, 2002; cf. Castorina, 2010; Jovchelovitch, 2010; Leman, 2010; Psaltis, 2012b, 2012c) in the transition from representations of belief to representations of knowledge[1] in the public sphere (see Moscovici, 1998/2000) and sociogenetic processes. One field of research that affords the exploration of sociogenetic processes in historical time is that of conflict transformation in societies, and changing representations of conflict and its roots. In this sense the Cypriot context of a divided and post-conflict society is an ideal setting for the expansion

of these ideas into an exploration of sociogenetic processes, especially the contact between members of the two communities that was made possible in divided Cyprus after the partial lifting of travel restrictions in 2003.

Intergroup contact and the reduction of prejudice in Cyprus

This second line of research relates to the exploration of social interaction as the motor of sociogenetic changes in relation to societal change. In situations of intergroup conflict it is well known that divisive social representations in the conflicting societies are characterized by negative stereotypes, prejudice and distrust. Bar-Tal and Teichman (2005), for example, argue that an infrastructure of conflict is often found in protracted conflicts that consists of shared societal beliefs about the ethos of the conflict, collective memory and emotional collective orientations.

These beliefs are the result of conflict but at the same time they could cement or even further escalate conflict if they were to become polemical representations since then they would become a fine example of what Moscovici (1998/2000, p. 136) calls social representations "whose kernel consists of beliefs which are generally more homogenous, affective, impermeable to experience or contradiction, and leave little scope for individual variations". The example of the official or master narratives of history promoted by the educational system under such conditions showcases these characteristics (Makriyainni & Psaltis, 2007; Carretero, 2011).

So a major question that arises from a conflict-transformation perspective concerns how such representations can be transformed into social representations, that Moscovici describes as being "founded on knowledge", "which are more fluid, pragmatic, amenable to the proof of success or failure, and leave a certain latitude to language, experience, and even to the critical faculties of individuals" (Moscovici, 1998/2000, p. 136).

One of the most prominent and influential approaches in the field of intergroup relations has been the work on "contact hypothesis" proposed by Gordon Allport (1954). The notion of cooperation is found in Allport's[2] contact hypothesis as one of the necessary conditions for contact to take place that would lead to societal change through prejudice reduction between conflicting groups. In his book *The nature of prejudice*, he hypothesizes that contact between members of different groups with a history of conflict, mistrust and prejudice could lead to the reduction of prejudice provided that four conditions are met. In his words,

> Prejudice (unless deeply rooted in the character structure of the individual) may be reduced by equal status contact between majority and minority groups in the pursuit of common goals. The effect is greatly enhanced if this contact is sanctioned by institutional supports (i.e. by law, custom or local atmosphere), and provided it is of a sort that leads to the perception of common interests and common humanity between members of the two groups.
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> (Allport, 1954, p. 281)

More recent empirical research on intergroup contact has not only verified Allport's hypothesis (Hewstone & Brown, 1984; Gaertner & Dovidio, 2000; Pettrigrew & Tropp, 2006) but also explored when contact works and why it does. Researchers have tried to do this by testing linear models of causality from contact to the reduction of prejudice or promotion of trust through the mediating role of a host of variables, such as the reduction of intergroup anxiety, the reduction of feelings of threat (realistic and symbolic) (Stephan & Stephan, 1985), perspective-taking and categorization.

Intergoup contact between Greek Cypriots and Turkish Cypriots in Cyprus

This research programme comprises more than 20 studies in total that are currently summarized in the form of a meta-analysis (Psaltis & Ioannou, in preparation). The studies cover children aged 9 years and over, and they follow various methodologies: cross-sectional questionnaire large-scale surveys (Tausch et al., 2010; Psaltis et al., 2011; Lytras & Psaltis, 2011; Psaltis, 2012a), longitudinal (Psaltis & Lytras, 2012) and qualitative (Psaltis, Beydola, et al., 2014; Psaltis, Cabrera et al., 2014).

Ontogenetically, there is evidence that prejudice in the GC community becomes established from early childhood, first by towards Turks, and indirectly and only later towards TCs (Makriyianni, 2006). The levels of prejudice of 12-year-olds towards TCs stay more or less the same up to the age of 15, with only a slightly decreased tendency after that with further reduction during the university years. The general trend is that half of the children have negative feelings (although only about 10–15 percent show extreme negative feelings), about one-third show neutral feelings and about 20 percent show positive feelings (rising to 30 percent for 15 years and over).

More interesting, however, is the relationships between forms of identification and prejudice for these age groups. Children, even up to 10–11 years of age, often have difficulties with multiple classifications

when it comes to abstract categories such as dual national identity. In Cyprus, Makriyianni (2006) found that GC pupils had a problem conceptualizing the dual identity of a "Greek Cypriot" and of a "Turkish Cypriot".

About 20–30 percent of 12-year-olds identify with the dual identity (GC) while most (55–60 percent) prioritize their superordinate identity (Cypriot). The feeling of pride associated with the dual identity (GC) at this age is, however, negatively related to identification with the superordinate category of Cypriot. Pride in being a GC is also linked with prejudice towards TCs and other groups (Kapetaniou, 2013). But this functional relationship between national identification with the dual identity and prejudice is only found at age 12 and re-emerges at age 15, when a sense of continuity with the Greek nation, often accompanied by adherence to the motto of extreme right-wing circles that "Cyprus is Greek", is incorporated into the definition of GC identity for these individuals. In line with this is the finding that 10–15 percent of children who show extreme negative feelings towards TCs and Turks often entertain exclusive forms of identification and prioritize Greekness over Cypriotness, identifying with the term "Greek".

The dominance of rather negative feelings towards TCs is also reflected in the ingroup norms of children regarding friendships with TCs. When 12–15-year olds were asked whether their friends would support and approve of them having a TC friend, most responded that their friends would disapprove of this move. Such norms, to an extent, reflect the ideological struggles and political party positions concerning the strategies for resolving the Cyprus issue and the attitudes of teachers themselves who are often ambivalent (Zembylas, 2011), if not outwardly hostile, to the idea of promoting intergroup contact in the educational system (Psaltis, in press).

Nevertheless, all studies covering children aged 9 and over demonstrate that contact in Cyprus has had a positive effect not only for the reduction of prejudice between the two communities, but also for the promotion of trust, with mean effect sizes comparable to the ones presented by Pettigrew and Tropp (2006) for various parts of the globe. The quality of contact in all studies is one of the stronger predictors of both prejudice reduction and increase in trust.

In all of our studies we used a measure of quality of contact that comprised both a dimension of symmetry-asymmetry of perceived status and a dimension of positivity-negativity of contact. As expected, the dimension of positivity-negativity significantly correlates with the dimension of symmetry-asymmetry, and often items from both

dimensions load on the same factor in factor analysis. Thus the Piagetian distinction between relations of cooperation and relations of constraint is very relevant for this field, as predicted by Allport (1954).

Importantly, research showed that politically oriented ideological positions that are historically rooted in the ideological struggles and nationalist aspirations of the two communities, which see Cyprus as part of Greece (called Hellenocentrism) and Turkey for TCs (discussed in the Cyprus problem literature as Turkocentrism) (see Peristianis, 1995) were consistently positively related to prejudice and distrust in both communities after the age of 15.

These orientations sometimes moderate the effects of intercommunal contact (the quantity and quality of contact) on the reduction of prejudice in adults. But interestingly, when such moderations take place, they go in the opposite direction in the two communities. In the GC community, the direction of moderating effects depends on the age and characteristics of the sample. Sometimes those with Cypriocentric orientations and supporters of federation, or the view that Cyprus is a common country for both GCs and TCs, show greater transformation of their prejudice levels since they show more prejudice reduction compared with GCs with more Hellenocentric orientations or those rejecting the idea of a federal solution to the Cyprus issue. In contrast, in the TC community, whenever the effects of contact are moderated, they indicate that the more Turkocentric and resistant they are to the ideal of a federal or a unitary state, the more they show prejudice reduction due to contact (Psaltis & Ioannou, in preparation), which resonates with recent findings by Hodson (2011) that more "hawkish" individuals benefit more from contact compared with "doves".

All of these findings lead to three conclusions. Firstly, it is not possible to extract a general universal model of contact that reduces prejudice when it comes to understanding the moderating effects of contact with ideological positions. Secondly, such moderating effects seem to vary, depending on the age of the participants. Thirdly, there is a need to explore both contact effects and the social representations of contact, and in particular whether contact is valourized, stigmatized or promoted by the governmental policy and parties or not, as originally proposed by Allport (1954).

Having said this, as already noted in the meta-analysis by Pettigrew and Tropp (2006), the present findings support the argument that contact is quite resilient to the moderating effects discussed above since in the majority of the studies there is no moderation by ideological orientation of contact effects on prejudice reduction. It needs to be clear

that the moderating effects that sometimes emerge are of a nature that suggests reduction or augmentation of the transformative potential, and in no case did we find contact leading to an increase in prejudice or hardening of positions.

Theoretically it is worth exploring further the counterintuitive moderating effects in the TC community that suggest the existence of a "sociocognitive conflict" effect. Generally, TCs have been led for many years by nationalist leaderships to think that they cannot live together with GCs, because GCs want to suppress and even annihilate them. So usually the views of TCs about GCs are rather negative, accompanied by a lot of mistrust (Psaltis, 2012a). Also, many TCs feel that GCs look down upon them, so with the backdrop of these expectations any positive or even neutral contact would comprise a positive violation of expectations. In contrast, in the case of GCs, and despite the somewhat negative feelings about TCs and high levels of distrust, the official discourse has been that "we have always lived in peace with TCs and we can do it again", or "we have no problem with TCs, the problem is occupation by Turkey" (see Psaltis et al., 2014). In this light we should not expect a great violation of expectations in the case of GCs when a positive or even neutral contact does take place. Another possibility to be explored by future research is that TCs are more reflective of the ideological struggles concerning history in their community since TC teachers are rather anti-nationalist (see Psaltis et al., 2011) and thus reflective of the "naïve realism" position of their official narrative. In Israel such awareness was recently found to make subjects with hawkish positions more open to positive change (Nasie et al., 2014).

Representations of the past and intergroup contact

The meanings described above usually have a direct connection to the past. So it becomes obvious that more attention needs to be paid to the relationship between social representations of history and how they relate to intergroup contact. This is an innovative turn in the field since it brings the study of social representations of history within the purview of contact theory, breaking new ground, and it resonates with ongoing discussions in the field of history teaching in relation to national identity (see Carretero, 2011), as well as recent research on the relationship between official historical narratives, collective memory and prejudice in post-conflict societies (see Bar-Tal & Salomon, 2006; Nasie et al., 2014).

As predicted, intergroup contact in many cases from adolescence onwards was an opportunity for the transformation of social representations of the past. The changes went in two directions:

- First was the direction of decentring, to the extent that the revised views reduced the rejection of ideas from the official viewpoint of the other community and showed increased empathy with regard to the victimization of the other community.
- The second kind of change concerned those that supported a more anti-imperialist discourse for TCs and the reduction of a sense of continuity of Hellenism in Cyprus in the case of GCs, which is more characteristic of a leftist discourse in both communities of Cyprus.

Longitudinal, cross-lagged analyses also suggest that accumulated contact can reduce adherence to the historical narrative six months later. In addition, adherence to the official narrative was predicting reduced quality of contact six months later, which is in line with the more general findings regarding the vulnerability of quality of contact in relation to various variables that are usually explored as outcomes rather than predictors of contact (e.g. prejudice, trust, the wish to live with the other community).

Such findings suggest a spiral of societal change and stability. On a positive spiral of change, prolonged and good-quality intergroup contact reduces adherence to official narratives, which in turn enhances the quality of future intergroup contacts. The corresponding negative spiral is that of adherence to the official narrative, reducing the quality of contact, which probably further reduces the possibilities for revision of the official narrative during social interaction. The latter negative spiral seems to become more likely with strategic use of contact as a weapon against reconciliation; on the contrary it becomes less likely if individuals are helped to reflect on the naïve epistemological bases of official historical narratives (cf. Nasie et al., 2014).

In order to explore the role of representations of history as formative influences on intergroup relations, we created a new variable which captured adherence to the official historical narrative of the community because this is usually depicted in the history textbooks, and then tested its effects on prejudice reduction, trust-building and the wish to live again with members from the other community in a representative sample taken from former inhabitants of mixed villages of both communities.

We also tested the following as possible mediators: symbolic threat (Stephan & Stephan, 1986), group esteem threat and intergroup anxiety (Lytra & Psaltis, 2011). The results for the GC community were very clear. Adherence to the official historical narrative was inflating the feeling of threat and anxiety, which in turn resulted in a reduction in trust, the wish to live together again with the other community and an increase in prejudice towards TCs.

In the TC community the results for representations of the past were largely unrelated to all of the aforementioned variables but this probably has to do with the special and symbolically strategic nature of mixed villages for TCs, which is discussed later.[3] The amount of current contact with members from the other community and past friendships in the village, on the contrary, was significant in predicting a reduction in threats and anxiety, and through these routes the promotion of trust, the wish to live together with members of the other community as well as prejudice reduction. This latter finding applied to both communities.

Further research using a representative sample from both communities (Psaltis & Lytras, 2012) tested a comprehensive Structural Equation Model in which the quantity of contact and adherence to the official narrative were predictors, and realistic threat, collective group esteem and intergroup anxiety were mediators that in turn predicted trust and prejudice. All of these mediators then predicted the wish to live again with members of the other community. The models worked in exactly the same way in both communities, which in effect implies that contact and adherence to official narratives work in antagonistic ways. In the same study we tested cross-lagged associations between a number of predictors (quantity of contact, quality of contact and adherence to the official narrative) and outcomes (prejudice, trust, wish to live with members of the other community). The results for the GC community suggested direct paths from all predictors to all outcomes.

However, in the case of quality of contact it was clear that reciprocal models were better at representing the data. This resonates with the strategic valourization of contact in the GC community that apparently reduces the quality of contact, as would be predicted by Gillespie's (Chapter 6, this volume) notion of semantic barriers to contact. For TCs there were direct paths from quantity of contact to all outcomes, and a reciprocal model in the case of a wish to live with GCs, which again resonates with the strategic reduction in the value of contact by those not wishing to live together with GCs in mixed areas.

One of the important extensions of the work on intergroup contact is what has recently been called exploration of the secondary transfer effects (STEs) of intergroup contact (Pettigrew, 2009) and the mediating processes through which it takes place. The STE refers to the phenomenon in which the beneficial effects of contact with a primary outgroup are generalized to other outgroups that are uninvolved in social interaction that is perceived as similar to the primary outgroup. This work is important for societal change because it is also

supported by a mediating process of extending the ethical horizon of the ingroup to encompass a more inclusive complex and multicultural view of society and a less provincial view of the world (Pettigrew, 2009). Indeed, in a comparative piece of research (see Tausch et al., 2010) with data from Cyprus, Northern Ireland and the USA, we were in a position to identify for Cyprus both deprovincialization and attitude generalization from the primary to secondary outgroup as mediators of STEs.

Theoretical implications for contact research and extensions

As in the case of the first line of research described earlier, it appears that there is more need for attention to the alignment or conflict of actual positions taken in social interaction and expectations keep furnished at the social representational level. This hypothesis of sociocognitive conflict between the actual and the expected as having a transformative role in social interaction is thus worthy of further exploration and points to the need to study the content of representations, as suggested by Gillespie (Chapter 6). Another suggestion by Gillespie in this volume is the exploration the role of meta- and metametaperspectives in intergroup contact. For example, we found that when GCs believed that TCs thought of them with contempt (a metaperspective), then contact was not having any effect on them, and this was found to apply only to GC women. This is probably due to the existence of stereotypes of TCs having traditional patriarchal views about gender equality that would make GC women particularly defensive.

In special populations in both communities that see themselves as guardians of a national cause and of the official historical narrative (a number of GC teachers and TC inhabitants of formerly mixed villages), we found evidence of a strategic conception of contact being evoked. For example, GC teacher trade unions back in 2009 sent a circular that forbade headteachers from accepting visits from students and teachers of TC schools, as they saw it as a form of indirect recognition of the internationally non-recognized state in the occupied areas. Similarly, TC former inhabitants of mixed villages in their vast majority do not want to live in mixed areas in the future (Lytras & Psaltis, 2011). As a result they are particularly strategic in avoiding offering descriptions of good-quality intercommunal relations of the past in their villages in oral history accounts (Psaltis et al., 2014). And when they accept that such relations did exist they usually follow a strategy of dissociating the importance of good intercommunal relations for a future solution of the Cyprus issue.

In short, the more strategic people become in their metathinking about contact, the more likely it is that they could employ what Gillespie calls "semantic barriers" to inoculate themselves and others from the transformative effects of contact. Still, even in the context of such populations in Cyprus, we found that contact does reduce prejudice. The dissociation concerns the relationship between adherence to the official narrative and prejudice, not the relationship between contact and prejudice. This finding suggests an instrumental and superficial adherence to the official narrative, as a thin layer of beliefs as Piaget (1932/1965) would argue, mastered but not appropriated, which was not consequential for their attitudes towards members of the other community since many participants just paid lip service to the official narrative without having internalized or functionally integrated it into their thinking.

Questions raised from the genetic social psychological perspective

On the whole the findings of both lines of research advocate a more socioculturally situated understanding of the transformation of representations through the articulation of microgenetic, ontogenetic and sociogenetic processes. This is the vision of genetic social psychology as discussed at the beginning of this chapter. From this perspective, current social developmental theories that attempt to explain prejudice are overly focused on either the projection of cognitive developmental theories on the understanding of the development of prejudice (Aboud, 1988; Bigler & Liben, 2007) or the application of classical social psychological theories, such as that of Social Identity Theory in children (Nesdale, 2004). These approaches can be criticized for a number of reasons: (1) they leave the "black box" of social interaction unopened and they are thus "non-developmental", to use Valsiner's (2013) expression; (2) they are premised on the cognitivist reading of Piagetian theory as individualist and stage theorist (Hsueh, 2009), systematically downplaying the social psychology of Piaget (Kitchener, 2009; Psaltis & Zapiti, 2014); and (3) they do not recognize the socioculturally situated and emergent nature of self and agency through the dual process of identification and being identified, as well as the role of resistance (Duveen, 2001).

The need to revisit Piaget and Weil's (1951) work

The genetic social psychological framework raises the need for some fundamental rereading of Piaget (Psaltis & Zapiti, 2014), since Aboud's

(1988) reading of Piaget and Weil (1951) in terms of the ontogenesis of prejudice (which influenced all subsequent researchers) suppressed the social psychological theory of Piaget, and extracted only the structuralist aspects of his theory (ethnic constancy from conservation, multiple classification from class inclusion, the shift away from egocentrism to more decentred views). But for Piaget and Weil (1951), gradual development was constantly exposed to deviations relating to the mode of social relations that the children were engaged in (relations of constraint or relations of cooperation). It was only through the latter that a norm of reciprocity could emerge. However, Piaget and Weil (1951) themselves were silent regarding the varying forms that such social relationships could take depending on the hostile or friendly relations between groups as the children went on to late childhood and adolescence.

Social relations within the ingroup (contact with a close circle of ingroup members) could have different consequences for norms compared with contact with both ingroup members and strangers of the ingroup, or even strangers from outgroups, not to mention the enemy "other". Social norms developed by the group, under conditions of intergroup tension and conflict, are expected to be different from the norms developed under cooperative conditions between groups. The way in which an individual conforms, resists, internalizes or interiorizes social relations with both ingroup and outgroup members needs to be better understood.

It is possible, for example, that explicitly expressed prejudicial views in early childhood will not be consequential for social interaction (Nesdale, 2004). On the contrary, implicit measures might be more predictive of social interaction and exclusionary behaviour. Such implicit forms of prejudice, as in the case of gender, could be formed quite early, premised on a very simple binary distinction between ingroup and outgroup that is at the same time valourized, which is the figurative nucleus of the social representations of gender in younger children (Duveen & Lloyd, 1990). At the same time it is possible that specific forms of conversation types (Psaltis & Duveen, 2006) taking place during intergroup contact could be differentially related to the reduction in implicit or explicit measures. Thus there is certainly a need for complicated experimental designs of the form of pretest, interaction with both immediate and delayed post-tests and control groups (and both implicit and explicit measures of prejudice) so that transient and superficial changes can be disentangled from more permanent and more generalizable prejudice reduction of both kinds of prejudice and in different age groups.

The need to understand identity as the dual process of identification and being identified

Identity is not only about identification but also about being identified (Duveen, 2001; Psaltis, 2012a). In this sense the relational aspects of contact and stereotypes (see literature on metastereotypes, Shelton & Richeson, 2006; West & Dovidio, 2012) also need to be considered. For example, it is worth exploring not only the perspective of the research subject on the quality of contact, but also their metaperspective of the assumed evaluation of contact by their partner in social interaction and their metametaperspective that concerns what they make of the other's interpretations of their own evaluations of contact.

What we have identified in the third generation of research is that different conversation types incorporate varying forms of recognition of Self by Other (e.g. "instrumental" or as a "thinking subject") (Psaltis & Duveen, 2006) and resistance. Such forms of recognition and resistance might not be reflected upon in the same manner across ages and themselves refer to different orders of reflection. We have argued in the past that social representations of gender might not be reflectively thematized in the interaction of 6–7-year olds, but older children do become capable of such reflection (Zittoun et al., 2003; Martin & Gillespie, 2010; Psaltis, 2012b). This suggests that identity threats evoked in social interaction based on metastereotypes might not be present for younger children but only for older children, if not only for adolescents, so future research needs to explore the level of reflection on the quality of social interaction and its consequences for prejudice reduction at different ages.

The need to acknowledge the complex interplay of varying sources of asymmetry in social interaction

The dynamics of communication in cross-ethnic interactions are expected to be influenced not only by the belonging of a child to a group, by their partner's belonging to the same or a different group or by the asymmetry of knowledge on the task that they are working on, but the interaction of all of these factors that bring to the surface the opposite dynamics emerging from the conflicting or, on the contrary, aligned nature of asymmetries of status and knowledge in cross-group social interactions (see Psaltis & Duveen, 2006, 2007; Psaltis & Zapiti, 2014). Such complex experimental dyadic designs will not only greatly advance our understanding of the differential impact of contact on both majority and minority members (cf. Levy & Killen, 2008), but also allow questions such as: When an interlocutor improves their attitude

towards the other, what happens to the partner? This kind of design will also allow for the use of dyadic models and analysis such as the Actor-Partner Interdependence Model that was previously used in the first line of research (Psaltis, 2005a; Zapiti, 2012) and that is now starting to be applied in the field of intergroup contact (West & Dovidio, 2012).

To sum up, there is a need to conceptualize intergroup contact as a complicated form of communication in the triad of Subject-Object-Other (Zittoun et al., 2007). In this triad, any link between the components can become an element of reflection or sociocognitive conflict, and it is such moments of reflection that become opportunities for reconfiguring the whole triadic configuration – in other words, the transformation of a social representation.

Notes

1. Moscovici's (1998/2000, p. 136) distinction is between a) social representations "whose kernel consists of beliefs which are generally more homogenous, affective, impermeable to experience or contradiction, and leave little scope for individual variations" and b) social representations founded on knowledge "which are more fluid, pragmatic, amenable to the proof of success or failure, and leave a certain latitude to language, experience, and even to the critical faculties of individuals" and clearly relates back to his social influence model of minority influence and through that to Piaget's (1932; 1967/1995) social psychological model of relations of constraint vs. relations of cooperation.
2. It is worth noting that Allport was only a year younger than Piaget; he had travelled in Berlin in 1922 and Cambridge in 1923, and he also visited Freud and he must have met Piaget at least twice: firstly when Piaget was awarded his first honorary doctorate at Harvard in 1936, and then in 1960 when Piaget was invited to Harvard by Jerome Bruner to give a talk. Jerome Bruner (1983) recalls that in the 1940s at Harvard, "We all knew about Piaget. I cannot remember a time when I didn't!" The extent to which Allport appreciated Piaget's work is questionable, though, since as the Chairman of the Department of Psychology at Harvard in 1935 he did not nominate Piaget for the honorary doctorate. Rather, the nomination came from members of the central executive committee for the honorary degrees that comprised a multidisciplinary group that was closely affiliated with the work of Elton Mayo and the human relations movement in the Harvard Business School and their work on the Hawthorn experiments (see Hsueh, 2009).
3. This interpretation is supported by the fact that the same variable was found to predict all of the variables of the model in a representative sample of the whole TC community (Psaltis & Lytras, 2012).

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